summits or, more frequently, in transgovernmental networks of officials from finance ministries, central banks, and other ministries. For example, meeting as the G6 in 1974, the group agreed on a new regime of floating exchange rates and changes in the IMF's articles of agreement after the collapse of the Bretton Woods fixed exchange rate system in 1971.[98]

Since 2005, the G7 also has experimented with attempts to coopt challengers through outreach processes (e.g., the "G8+5" emerging economies) and "special relationships"; but these efforts were resented by emerging economies as second-best alternatives to being full members in core decision-making bodies. Russia was the sole transitional power that joined the G7 (in 1997, when it became known as the G8), but its special circumstances precluded Moscow joining the G7 financial group,[99] and its G8 membership was suspended in 2014 over Western opposition to Russia's armed intervention in Ukraine and annexation of Crimea. Moreover, the outdated geopolitical logic of the incumbent powers' outreach process still left China on the outside when Russia incongruously assumed the rotating presidency of the G8 in 2006 (and was ecstatic about its elevated insider status). Displaying well-oiled diplomatic aplomb in the practice of double standards, the Russian government voiced approval of the G8,[100] and just a few months after the June summit in St. Petersburg invited three of the "outreach" states to consult as dissatisfied BRICs on the sidelines of the autumn U.N. session in New York. As the global financial crisis intensified, Brazil called for disbanding the G8, an idea that French President Nicolas Sarkozy suggested he would entertain when Paris presided over the group in 2011. The United States, Japan, and other members of the original G7 club blocked this move, refashioning the G20 instead into a new apex club of the twenty largest world economies while preserving the original G7/G8 group.

THE BRICS AS A CLUB

Given that rising and incumbent great powers are socialized in international politics to emulate the successful strategies and instruments of their competitors,[101] it is not surprising that nascent coalitions of emerging powers were evident when the BRICs emerged on the diplomatic scene. The most important of these coalitions in terms of international impact emerged in the WTO during the Doha Round of negotiations, as first Brazil